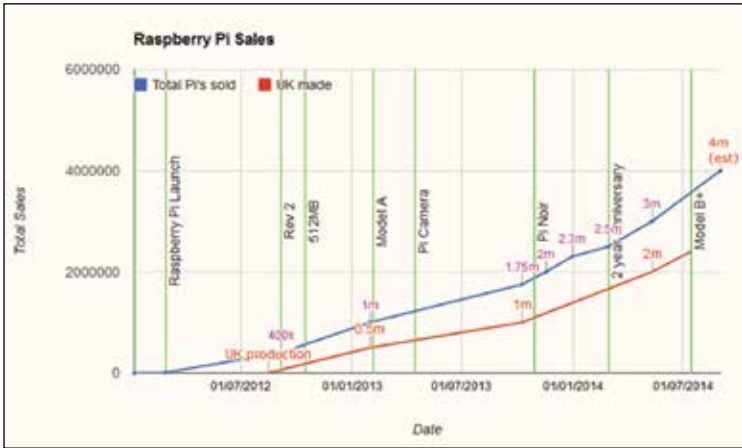




The Pi is expected to double sales in the next two years.

was only created because of the overwhelming demand for the project. It is worth remembering that the initial product run of the Pi was planned to be around 10,000 throughout its lifetime.

It surpassed that in pre-orders by a factor of 10 when people started taking an interest. In order to meet the production requirements necessary to produce millions of units, they partnered with private companies like Broadcom and Sony to ensure affordable assembly and components. This required a certain tradeoff which still restricts them from making the hardware design open source, but it is a cost worth paying to ensure the availability of the device to any young child looking to learn programming and computer sciences. In short, the Raspberry Pi doesn't cut corners just because it is cheap - it is a precision tool for educational purposes. And while its fame comes from its off-label usage in maker projects, that isn't their primary audience. They have even said that the best thing they hope for is that some Chinese company cracks their design and starts selling versions that are cheaper, since it will make it more accessible.

Unofficial Accessories

The Raspberry Pi can be used in thousands of different ways. But to truly unlock its advanced features it helps to have add-ons. Apart from the basic accessories such as multiple micro USB cables, at least 4 GB mini SD storage card, USB keyboard, USB mouse and an HDMI compatible screen there are